Tamsin River Water Quality Study 2024

1. Background

Samples were collected from 14 monitoring stations along the Tamsin River between March and October 2024, giving 1,176 laboratory analyses in total. The study was commissioned by the Riverside District Council following algal blooms in 2023.

2. Results

Nitrate concentrations varied substantially between upstream and downstream stations.

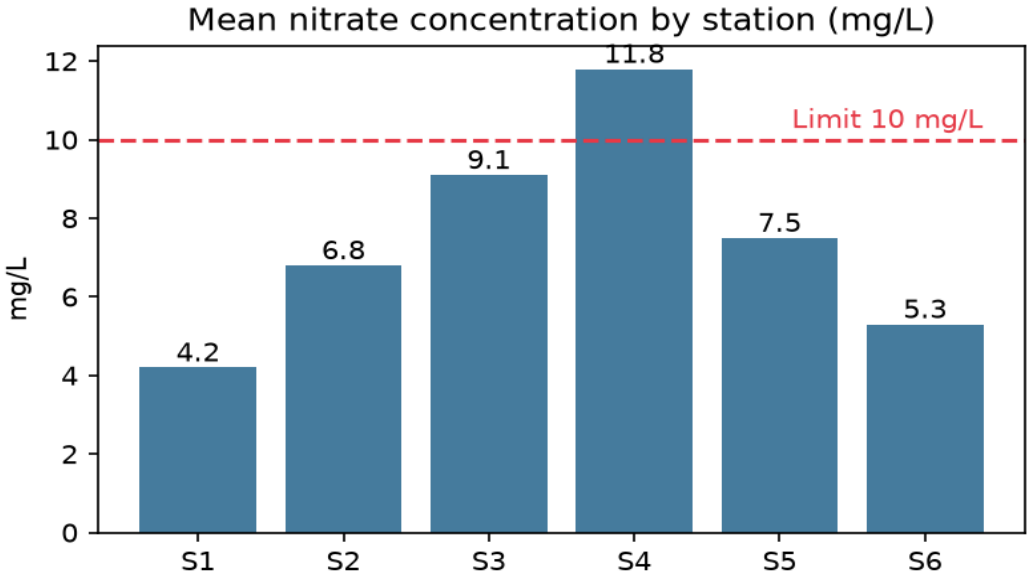


Figure 1: Mean nitrate concentration by station

Parameter	Mean value	Unit
Lead	3.2	µg/L
Phosphate	0.41	mg/L
Dissolved oxygen	7.9	mg/L
Turbidity	4.6	NTU

Table 1: Summary of other measured parameters

3. Station locations

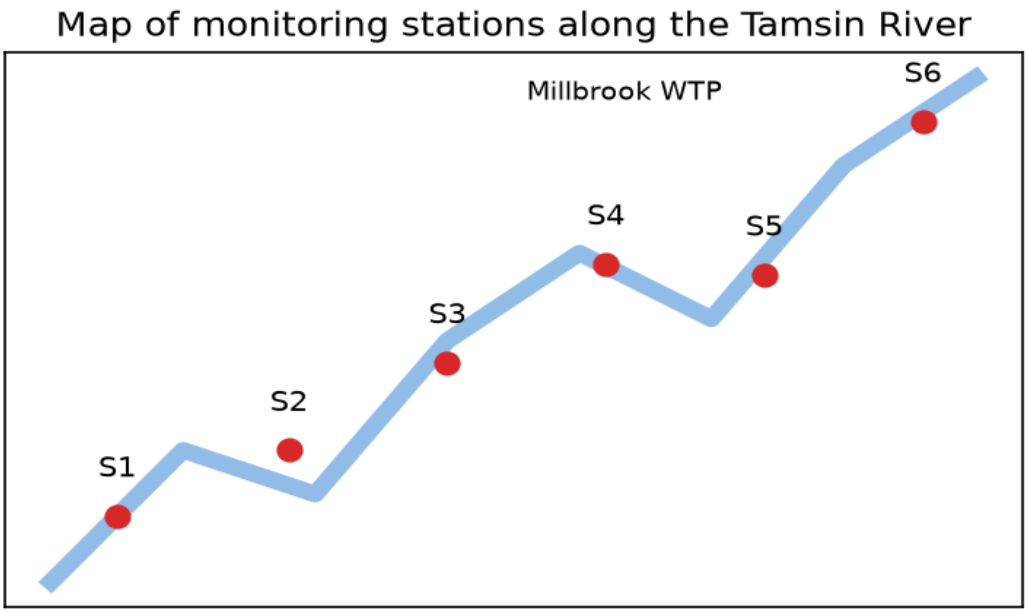


Figure 2: Station map

4. Conclusions

Nutrient loading downstream of the agricultural belt is the main pressure on the river. The study recommends upgrading the Millbrook treatment plant with tertiary nutrient removal by 2027.